



REPUBLIC OF ZAMBIA

MINISTRY OF LOCAL GOVERNMENT AND RURAL DEVELOPMENT

Council Citizen Engagement Strategy

(With a Focus on Output Based Budgeting and
Project Implementation Management)

Zambia Devolution support program
2025

Contents

Town Council Citizen Engagement Strategy.....	Error! Bookmark not defined.
1. Introduction	2
1.1 Background	2
1.2 Current C.E. Efforts by Council	2
2. Vision, Aim and Objectives.....	2
3.Approaches and Methods of Engagement	3
4. Implementation Plan	3
5. Communication Plan.....	4
6. Budget (for the Implementation of the CE Process)	5
7.Monitoring, Evaluation and Reporting	5
8. Conclusion.....	5
Annex	5

1. Introduction

Section Content Notes:

You may refer to the CES guideline to populate this section. The text may include:

1.1 Background

- a) Provide a brief description of the importance of citizen engagement in democratic governance and the budget process at local level;
- b) A statement that certain legal and policy obligations are being fulfilled;
- c) You may also emphasize on the development of this document as a plan to achieve the goals to empower citizens, improve decision-making, and foster trust between government and the public.

1.2 Current C.E. Efforts by Council

- a) Provide a description of the CE efforts that the council has invested in during the budgeting and project cycle processes.
- b) Highlight the advantages/benefits and disadvantages/gaps of these CE efforts and state how the CES will contribute to the execution of these stated efforts.

E.g.

- i. Deliberate expansion of target groups for more inclusive participation in CE activities such as people living with disabilities, women, community and traditional leaders etc.
- ii. More information will be shared with the citizens on updates and decisions over the budget and project cycle processes.

2. Vision, Aim and Objectives

Section Content Notes:

This section may be presented as the example given below:

2.1 Vision [State a vision that suits your context as a Council based on the main problem statement with regard to CE]

E.g. Creating an inclusive, transparent and participatory context that empowers citizens to contribute to development and decision making processes of council by 2028.

- a) During the three (3) year duration of CES, each year will contain an annual implementation plan. Feedback from each year will be incorporated in the following year action plan and a full revision will be submitted at the beginning of the 3rd year of the CES implementation period.

2.2. Aim [State an Aim that suits your context as a Council]

E.g. The main aim of this Strategy is to provide a structured approach for engaging citizens in the budget and project cycle processes to enable transparency, accountability, and inclusivity in public financial management of the council.

2.3 Objectives [State a minimum of 3 objectives. These would be statements committing to address existent CE related challenges]

E.g.

- a) Increase current levels of citizen awareness and understanding of the budget and project cycle processes.
- b) Enable more inclusion of citizens to participate in budget and project decision-making and prioritization.
- c) Improve mechanisms for citizen monitoring of budget and project implementation from current practice.

3. Approaches and Methods of Engagement

Text in this section may be presented as follows:

E.g.:

The council team will use the below stated initiatives for inclusive engagement taking into consideration that citizens are drawn from varying contexts. Consideration will be taken about how citizens will engage with civic leaders as well, to ensure that the process is not one sided. The citizen engagement process is on-going, hence the Councils intention to use different avenues and mechanisms to communicate with various stakeholders. Engagement methods will therefore include:

A. Citizen Participation in key Decision-Making and keeping citizens informed through the budget cycle:

- a) The presentation for the budget hearings will be presented ahead of time to stakeholders to obtain feedback including allocations to different programs/sub programs, key outputs, and selected projects;
- b) The CE in prioritizing projects will be strengthened to provide a good venue for informed consultation with WDCs;

B. Citizen Monitoring of Budget and Project Implementation

- a) CE in project implementation will be fostered via updated openings to engage citizens and local structures in monitoring project implementation;
- b) Improve reporting to citizens on the outputs of the budget implementation. This will be achieved using the following examples:
 - Use technology for real-time reporting on project progress;
 - Publish regular updates and reports;
 - Create accessible channels for concerns or feedback.
- c) Selected stakeholders will form part of the team as the council conducts monitoring visits.

4. Implementation Plan

Section content example is presented as follows:

The implementation plan of the CES will include the following:

1. Assessment of the current status of citizen engagement in the budget process and other relevant subject matters. [\[CES Guideline outlines this and may be referred to for the completion of this section\]](#)
2. Identify engagement opportunities and develop a detailed outline of timelines and responsibilities. Example given in Table 1 below.
3. Outline the Stakeholders with reference to the level of and period of engagement with the council.

As displayed in table 2 below, the stakeholders to be engaged by the council may include citizens, Ward Development Committees (WDCs), Neighborhood Health Committees (NHCs), Community Welfare Assistance Committees (CWACs), government agencies at various levels, community organizations, Traditional and Community leaders, businesses, civil society groups, academic institutions, media outlets, and potentially affected groups within the community. [\[Kindly provide the comprehensive list of Stakeholders the council collaborates with\]](#)

Table 1: Proposed Stakeholder Engagement Plan Summary Table [\[Outlines description of activities and Stakeholders for effective CE practices\]](#)

BUDGET STAGE	KEY FEATURES/ACTIVITIES	STAKEHOLDER CATEGORY INVOLVED	TIMELINE
Preparation for budget formulation	i. LAs provide communities with SEP giving proposed dates for consultation		
	ii. LAs provide WDCs with a list of proposed projects for consideration in this budget cycle as well as a list of ongoing projects and completed projects for the past 2 years.		

	iii.	Using the project lists provided, communities may accept or reject project proposals and make their own proposals for development projects and activities for their Wards to be included in the budget based on their priorities		
	iv.	LAs produce a summarized stakeholder report from all Wards and submit report to MLGRD.		
	v.	Conduct budget hearings & Town Hall meetings.		
	vi.	The Town Clerk/Council Secretary shall present the reports to the full council.		
	vii.	Feedback meetings to WDCs on what projects and activities have been included in the budget		
	viii.	Reports including minutes must be submitted to the PLGOs office for review and consolidation for onward submission to MLGRD.		
	ix.	MLGRD will submit the consolidated reports to MoFNP.		
Budget approval (public awareness of budget details)	i.	Review the proposed budget and assess whether input from community, especially vulnerable groups i.e. women, PWDs and children has been incorporated.		
	ii.	Feedback to WDCs and other stakeholders of the final approved budget		
Budget execution and monitoring (for transparency in budget implementation)	i.	Track the effective utilisation of funds in line with planned activities.		
	ii.	Report back on a regular basis to WDCs on implementation of activities and projects		
Budget evaluation and Review	i.	Evaluate the impact of allocated funds, focusing on agreed upon programmes with a bias towards gender, persons with disabilities, child-related and climate change outcomes.		

5. Communication Plan

Section Content Comments:

[This is to be developed with input from the Public Relations Officer]

1. Describes information dissemination by the council to create awareness over the CES and its contents.
2. It outlines details of different avenues to announce meeting details such as timing.
3. Should also include Grievance Redress Mechanism component to capture feedback from citizens.

Table 2: Proposed Communication Plan Summary

DELIVERABLE/ ACTIVITY	TARGET STAKEHOLDERS	FREQUENCY	PROPOSED TIMELINE/ DATE	RESPONSIBILITY	COMMUNICATION METHOD	COMMENTS

6. Budget (for the Implementation of the CE Process)

Section Content Example:

There will be consideration for the inclusion of budget lines to support the CES.

[You have the option to provide more details on this component]

7. Monitoring, Evaluation and Reporting

Section Content Comments:

- This provides a detailed account to monitor, report and evaluate progress, adjusting based on feedback and lessons learned from implementing the CE action plan.
- It will also include the commitment towards the use of the existent Feedback and Grievance Redress Mechanism (GRM) procedure to ensure for continuous flow of information over concerns or inquiries that may arise during the budget and project cycle phases.
- Monitoring Reports will be published via various platforms including the website, notice boards etc.

8. Conclusion

This may be populated with the content as follows:

- The development of this CES emphasizes the appreciation that the council has for citizen engagement in the democratic governance system and effective public spending for people centred development [You may include other content on how it will help systemise a process that has been existent but fragmented]
- In this section, you may emphasize the commitment to inclusivity, transparency, and accountability in the budget and project implementation processes.

Annex

[Relevant Templates will be jointly selected from the CES guidelines. These may include: Attendance list, Stakeholder minutes, Budget Hearing Presentation, Zonal and Ward project sheet, Monitoring sheets and others relevant to the L.A.]